



Alternatives to the banned chinese apps

The Indian government has banned 59 apps over security concerns, leaving users to find alternatives.

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The ban was no big loss as most of the apps banned were sidey anyways, and there was no good reason to have them on your phone. As far as utility is concerned, here are the alternatives for these apps, in the four major categories. These are short video sharing apps, file management, scanners and browsers.

SHORT VIDEO PLATFORMS

While the creators on the video sharing platform are cribbing about the sudden loss of their side hustles, the banning of Chinese apps over data mining concerns has opened up an opportunity for Indian developers. With the ban of TikTok, these creators are moving on to Instagram, or waiting Google's rumoured short video platform. However, there are multiple

Indian alternatives as well. Most of these apps have been around for some time now, and are well tuned with the local demands and requirements. One of the strong points of these apps is that they are localised, and most of them are available in Bengali, Tamil, Kannada, Gujarati, Hindi, Marathi, Odiya, Punjabi, Telugu and Malayalam apart from English. If the list says the apps are available in ten languages, these are those ten languages.

Chingari

Chingari is suddenly rocketing up the charts, with over 5,000,000 installs in just a few weeks. For the most part, it is just an endless stream of videos. You can login to follow creators to create a custom feed. Most of the content seems to be oriented towards dance or music, and only the very occasional joke video. In terms of content, Chingari is the platform that is the least like TokTok. The videos are not as diverse as TikTok, at least not yet. In terms of video editing, the app offers little functionality apart from the ability to add background music to your

videos, and cutting a video down to size. The idea is that you use a third party app to edit the videos, and just upload it on this platform. Keeping with the hot trends that have emerged during the lockdown, the app also allows you to play Bingo and Quiz with prize money. Chingari does not have an integrated Ludo feature at the time of writing. It is a barebones and glitchy app, but makes the list considering the insane popularity. This app is available in ten local languages.

Roposo

Roposo has been around for more than two years now, and has matured as a platform and is quite differentiated. It has more than 50,000,000 installs across both platforms. It features humorous content and dance videos that the users of TikTok will be familiar with. The content is organised in channels, such as comedy, dance, quotes, and technology. The hero feature of the app is the ability to download videos for repeated viewing. If there is a single Indian app that can give an experience most similar to what TikTok offers, it is Roposo. The app is available



The UI of Roposo

in ten local languages apart from English. The app comes fully integrated with powerful video editing tools, and at the same time is easy to use with a simple interface. There are a range of filters and